

Formative Evaluation - WeebCult

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December 21, 2025

Introduction

The purpose of this formative evaluation was to gather qualitative feedback during the last few days of the development of *WeebCult*, with the goal of identifying usability issues, architectural weaknesses, and interaction shortcomings early enough to improve the final application.

Feedback was collected from multiple reviewers, family members, friends, students, some die hard anime fans and some who became fans after trying the app. Feedback was also collected from people with varying familiarity with anime and web applications.

The following sections summarize and reflect upon the received feedback, structured consistently across reviewers in terms of first impression, likes and dislikes, suggested changes, and overall comments. The feedback directly informed several design and architectural improvements implemented in the later stages of development.

Feedback 1

First Impression

The first reviewer described the application as visually appealing and well designed, highlighting that the interface felt interactive and satisfying from the start. The black and purple color scheme was particularly appreciated and contributed to a strong initial impression. The overall concept of an anime-based quiz platform with multiple game modes was seen as interesting and engaging.

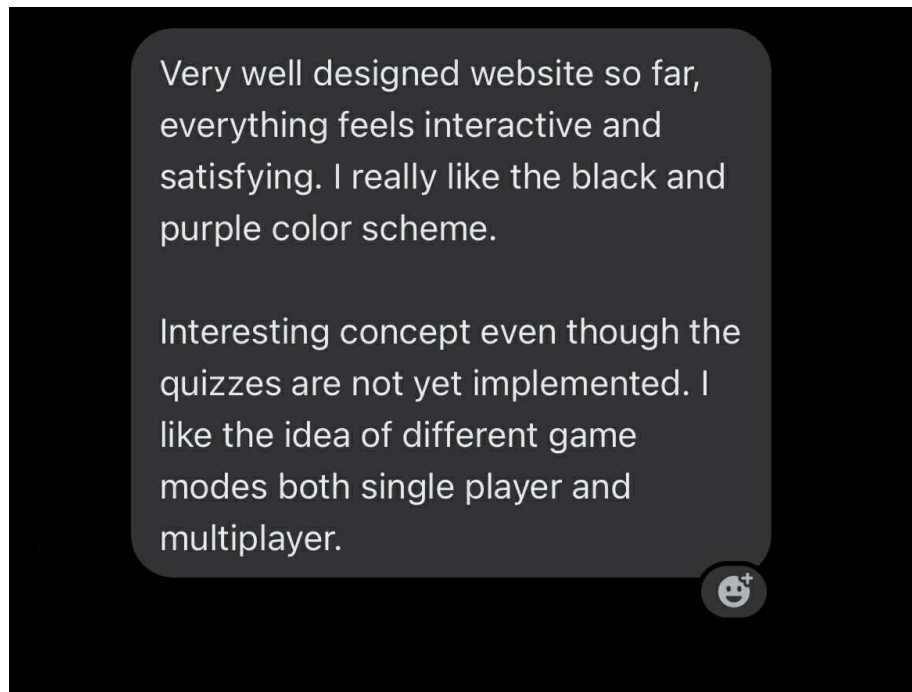


Figure 1: First impression of the app (feedback1)

What Was Liked and Disliked

The reviewer liked the overall interaction design and visual consistency, as well as the idea of supporting both single-player and multiplayer quiz modes.

However, several usability issues were identified. Category rows extended beyond the visible screen area and that there was no visible loading indicator during slower network conditions, resulting in a black screen that made the system state unclear. Some search filters appeared to behave inconsistently, and clickable elements such as anime detail links were not sufficiently visually distinguished.

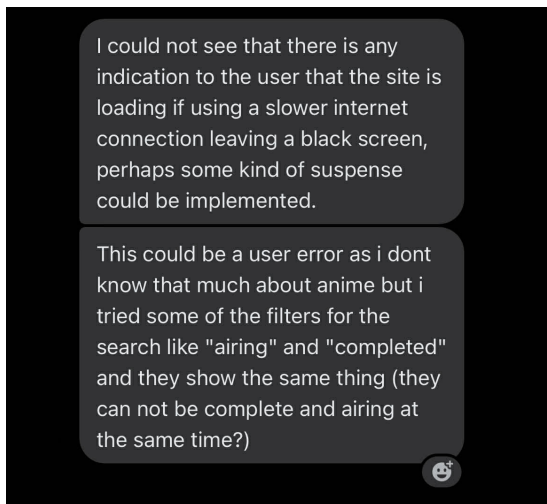


Figure 2: Issues identified (feedback1)

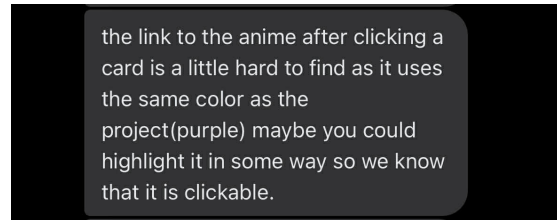


Figure 3: Issues identified (feedback1)

What Would Be Changed, Added, or Removed

Based on this feedback, improvements were made to:

- Introduce clear loading indicators using suspense views to improve visibility of system status.
- Clarify and correct search filtering behavior.
- Improve visual affordances for clickable links to make navigation more intuitive.

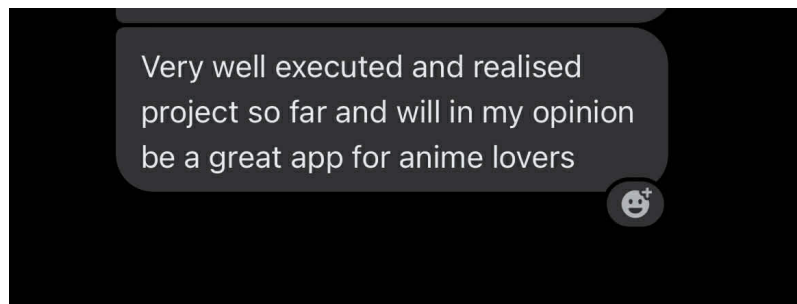


Figure 4: Small feedback (feedback1)

Small Feedback

Overall, the reviewer considered the project very well executed with a strong architectural foundation and good API usage. The feedback indicated that addressing visibility and interaction clarity issues would significantly improve usability.

Feedback 2

First Impression

The second reviewer noted that the application had a clean and consistent visual style, with navigation that was easy to understand. This helped users feel comfortable exploring the application without explicit instructions. The overall interaction design was seen as solid but in need of clearer system feedback.

What Was Liked and Disliked

The reviewer appreciated the responsiveness of the interface and the overall structure of the application.

However, the lack of feedback during loading states and error situations (such as starting a quiz without required selections) was seen as a weakness. Additionally, repeated clicks on the logo occasionally resulted in a black screen, indicating missing edge-case handling.

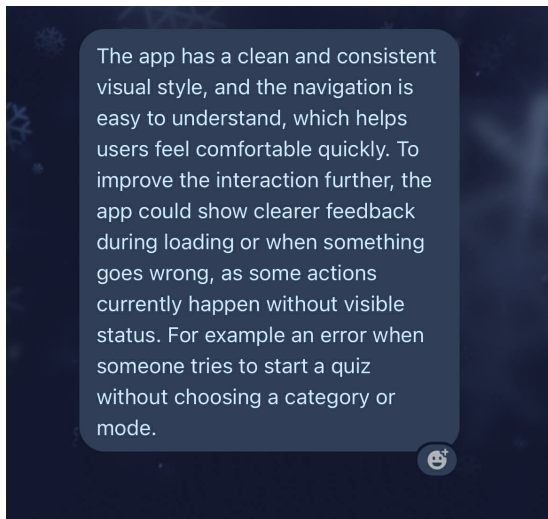


Figure 5: First impression and identified issues (feedback2)

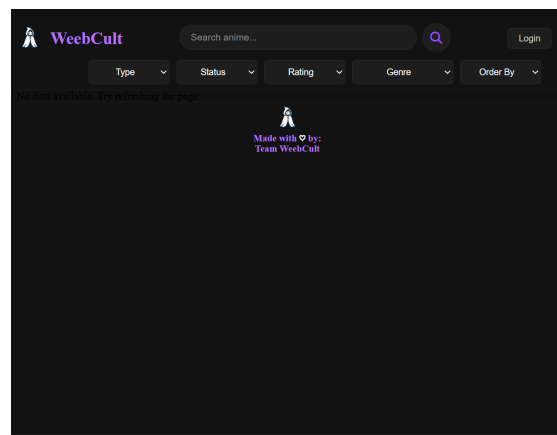


Figure 6: Issues identified with repeated clicks on the logo and repeated page refresh

What Would Be Changed, Added, or Removed

Following this feedback, focus was placed on:

- Adding clearer loading and error feedback to improve visibility of system status.
- Handling invalid user actions explicitly, such as attempting to start a quiz without required inputs. This was fixed by introducing an alert for the `handleOnPlayACB` in the `animeDetailsView`.

- Improving navigation robustness to avoid unintended blank states, as this was an issue with the API rate limit. The fix was to use retrying and implement some retry functions in the API source file of the app (animeSource.js).

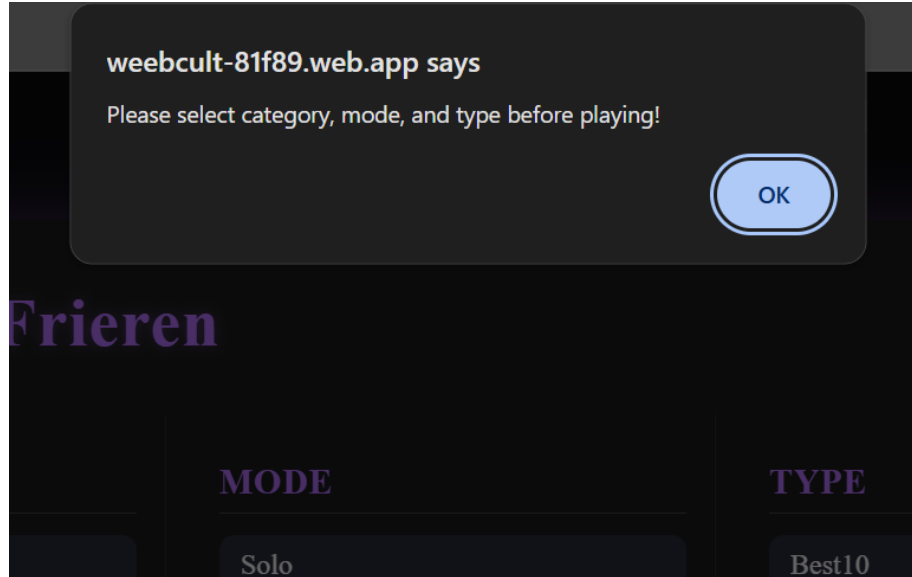


Figure 7: Added alert for starting a quiz without selecting the required inputs

Small Feedback

The reviewer concluded that the project was well executed, but emphasized that clearer feedback mechanisms were essential to maximize usability and architectural clarity.

Feedback 3

First Impression

The reviewer reported a very positive first impression of the application, describing it as engaging and enjoyable to use. The interactive elements and overall structure made the application feel polished and well thought out from the start.

What Was Liked and Disliked

The reviewer particularly appreciated the sidebar popup displaying the three most recently completed quizzes. The ability to interact with the cards and flip them to reveal detailed quiz statistics, such as score and quiz settings, was highlighted as a strong and enjoyable feature that enhanced user engagement.

However, two usability issues were identified. First, using the browser's *Back* button from the home page resulted in a blank screen, which was confusing and broke the navigation flow. Second, the

quiz configuration options in the anime details popup were not sufficiently clear or well aligned, making it difficult for users to understand that certain options must be selected before starting a quiz.

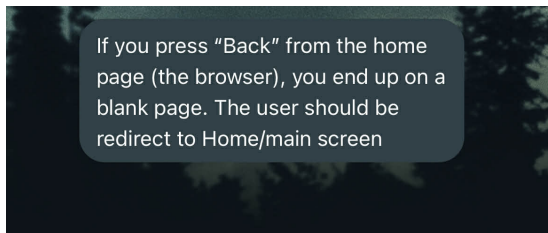


Figure 8: Identified issues for the app (feedback3)

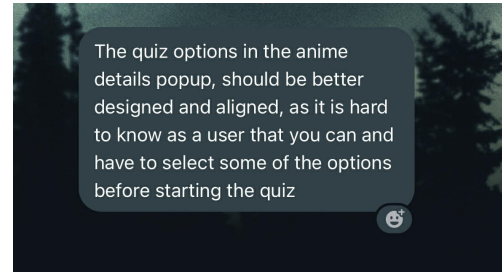


Figure 9: Suggestions for the app (feedback3)

What Would Be Changed, Added, or Removed

Based on this feedback, the following improvements were identified:

- Handling browser navigation more robustly by redirecting users to the home screen instead of displaying a blank page.
- Redesigning and better aligning quiz option controls in the anime details popup to clearly communicate their interactivity and required selection before starting a quiz.

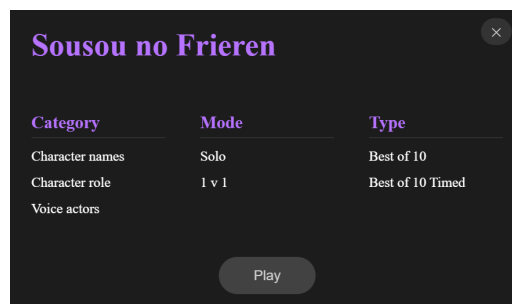


Figure 10: Improvements for the app after feedback

Small Feedback

Overall, the reviewer found the application highly enjoyable and praised the interactive sidebar as a standout feature. The feedback emphasized that improving navigation robustness and clarifying quiz setup options would further enhance usability and reduce potential user confusion.

Feedback 4

First Impression

The reviewer initially approached the application without prior interest in anime. Despite this, the first impression was very positive, and the reviewer reported becoming more engaged with both the application and anime content after using the app. The overall design, structure, and variety of features made the application approachable even for users outside the target anime fan base.

What Was Liked and Disliked

The reviewer appreciated the broad range of functionality offered by the application, including anime search and filtering, genre-based browsing, different quiz modes and categories, and the presence of a global leaderboard. These features made the app feel complete and engaging, even to a non-anime fan.

However, two usability issues were identified. First, as a new user, it was not immediately clear what actions were available upon first landing on the main page. Second, during gameplay, there was no obvious way to cancel an ongoing quiz or return to a previous screen, which reduced the sense of user control.

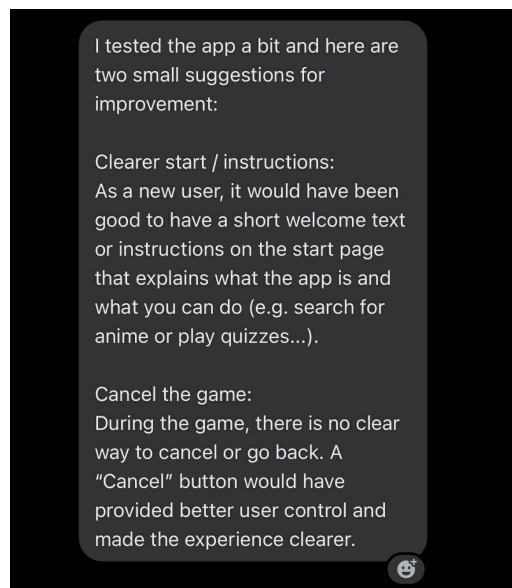


Figure 11: Suggestions for the app (feedback4)

What Would Be Changed, Added, or Removed

Based on this feedback, the following improvements were identified:

- Adding a short welcome message or introductory text on the start page to explain the core functionality of the app, such as searching for anime and playing quizzes.

- Introducing a clear *Cancel* button during quizzes to allow users to stop a game and return to the main screen at any time.

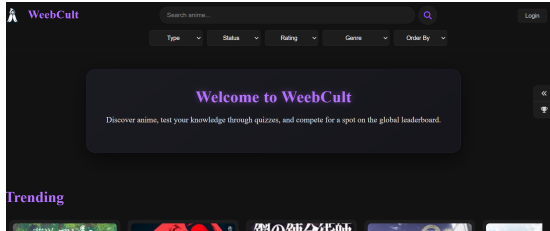


Figure 12: Improvement for the main screen after the feedback

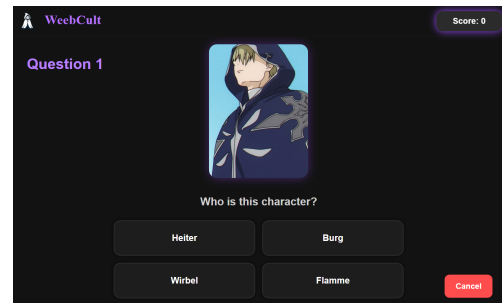


Figure 13: Improvement for the quiz/game screen after feedback

Small Feedback

Overall, the reviewer found the application enjoyable and easy to explore, even without prior anime knowledge. The feedback highlighted that small usability improvements related to onboarding and user control would further strengthen the user experience and make the application more accessible to first-time users.

Feedback 5

First Impression

The fifth reviewer expressed a very positive first impression, noting that the website looked polished and professionally structured. The concept was described as engaging enough to be used recreationally.

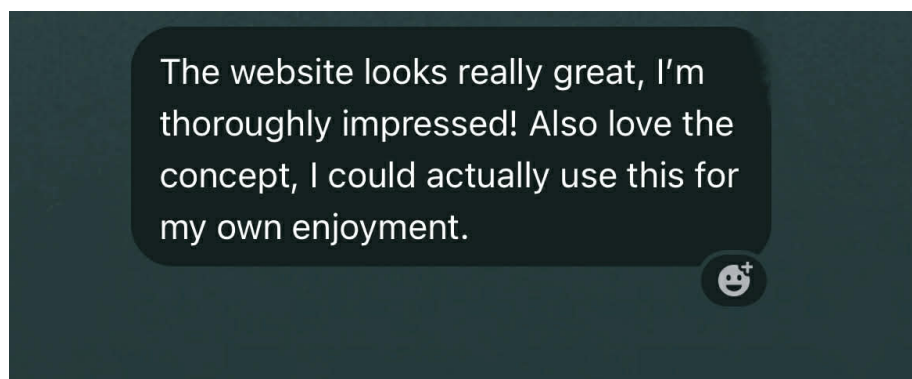


Figure 14: First impression of the app (feedback5)

What Was Liked and Disliked

The reviewer appreciated the clear separation of the app, as well as the modular UI design and use of popups were seen as evidence of careful planning.

However, some usability issues were identified, particularly around unclear interactivity. Quiz setup options were presented as plain text, making it difficult to recognize them as clickable. Some search filters also appeared inactive or unclear in their effect.

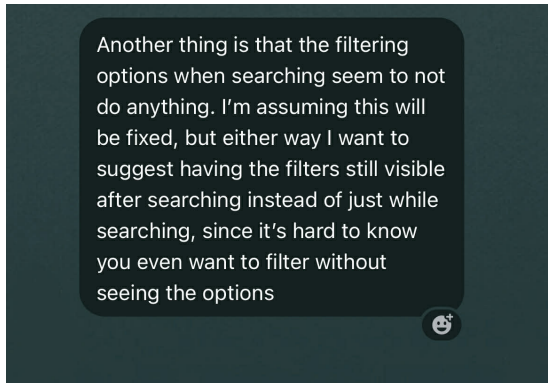


Figure 15: Identified issue with search filtering

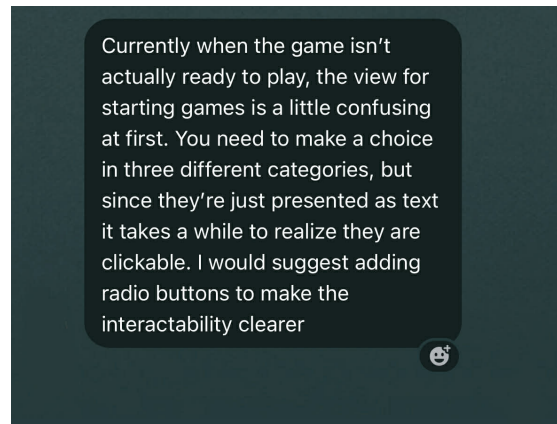


Figure 16: Suggestion for the quiz options

What Would Be Changed, Added, or Removed

In response to this feedback, improvements focused on:

- Making quiz configuration options more explicit through clearer affordances and the use of radio styled button options.
- Ensuring filters remain visible after searching to support recognition rather than recall. As before the user had to write in the input search, so that the filters become visible and usable. With this fix, the filter dropdown options are always visible, without the need to write anything in the search input.

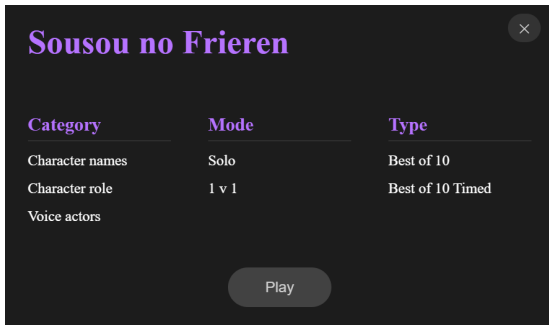


Figure 17: Quiz options before feedback

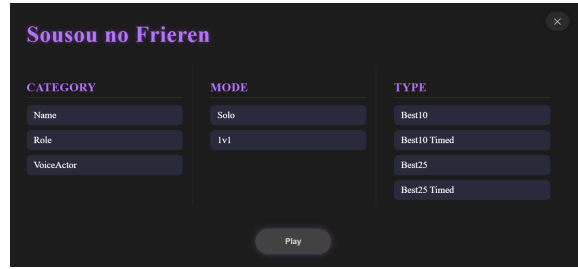


Figure 18: Quiz options after feedback

Small Feedback

The reviewer saw no major risks to the project’s success and emphasized that improving feedback on user actions and finalizing core functionality would elevate the application from a strong prototype to a fully polished product.

Feedback 6

First Impression

The reviewer reported a strong positive first impression of the application, particularly highlighting the visual design and color scheme. The layout of the main page, with multiple rows of anime organized by genre, was seen as engaging and easy to explore. The idea of a global leaderboard based on quiz points was also perceived as motivating and well suited to the quiz-based concept of the application.

What Was Liked and Disliked

The reviewer liked the overall aesthetics of the app, the clear genre-based presentation of anime on the main page, and the competitive element introduced by the leaderboard. These features contributed to an enjoyable and dynamic user experience.

However, a few usability and content-related issues were identified. In the case of less popular anime titles, some characters lacked images and were displayed as a white placeholder with a question mark, which negatively affected visual consistency. Additionally, after completing a quiz, the user was immediately redirected back to the main page, making it unclear how well they performed. Finally, the leaderboard and sidebar buttons on the main page were represented only by icons, which made their purpose unclear to new users.

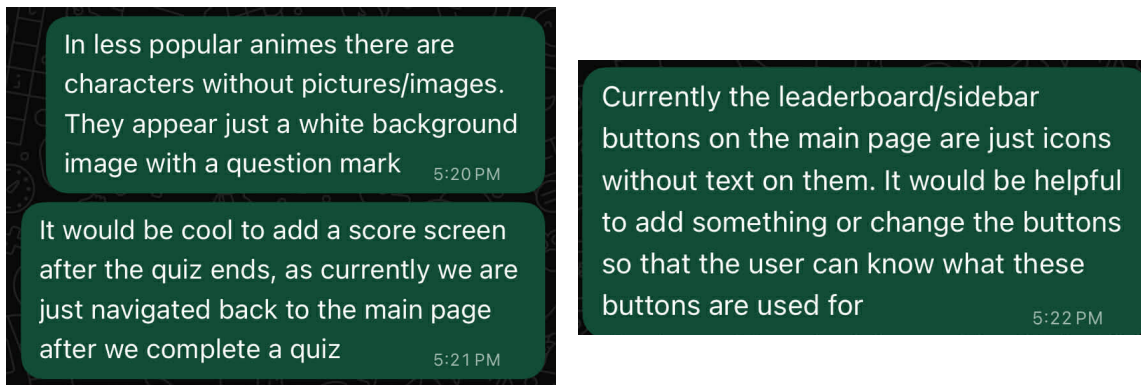


Figure 19: Identified issues and suggestions

Figure 20: Suggestions for the app

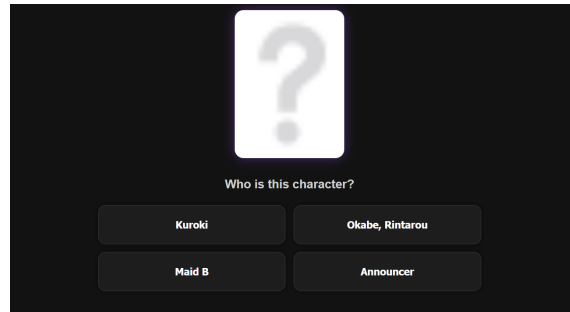


Figure 21: Issue with some images on the quiz screen

What Would Be Changed, Added, or Removed

Based on this feedback, the following improvements were identified:

- Improving the handling of missing character images by using clearer placeholders or fallback visuals. This was directly fixed from the API source file (animeSource.js), to make sure that unknown characters (characters missing an img) are skipped for the quiz and not rendered (fetched).
- Adding a dedicated score screen after quiz completion to clearly present results before returning to the main page. This was done by simply adding a new view and presenter (gameScore) to display the stats/score of the quiz the user played.
- Enhancing the leaderboard and sidebar buttons with text labels, tooltips (upon hovering), and clearer iconography to improve discoverability.

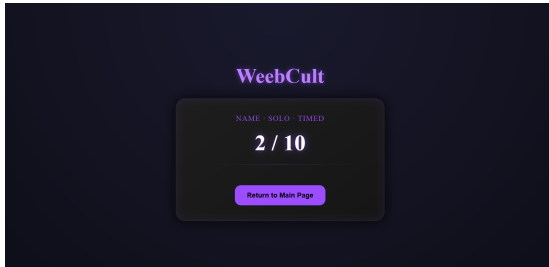


Figure 22: Score screen for Solo mode

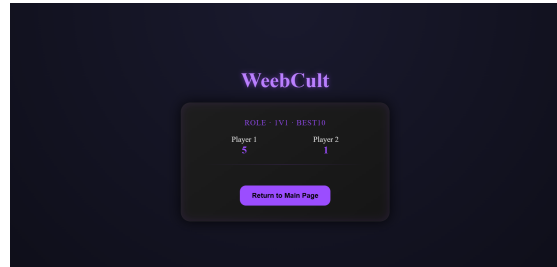


Figure 23: Score screen for 1v1 mode

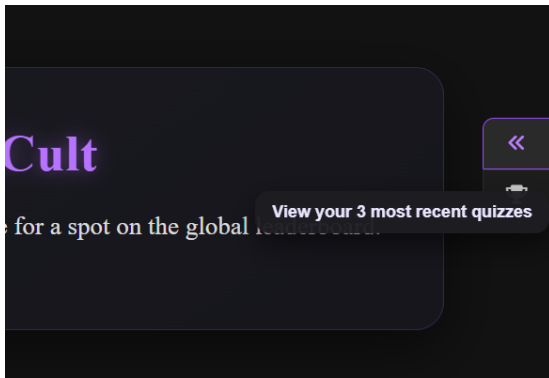


Figure 24: Updated tooltip for sidebar button

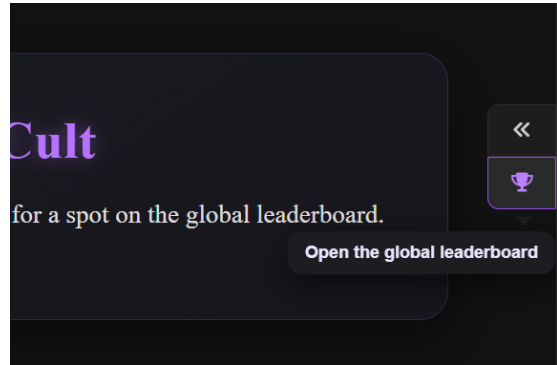


Figure 25: Updated tooltip for leaderboard button

Small Feedback

Overall, the reviewer found the application visually appealing and enjoyable to use, with strong ideas such as genre-based browsing and competitive leaderboards. The feedback emphasized that small improvements in visual consistency, feedback after quiz completion, and clearer navigation cues would significantly improve the overall user experience.

Feedback 7

First Impression

The reviewer expressed an extremely positive first impression of the application, describing it as simple, clear, and well structured. The ability to easily search and filter anime was highlighted as a strong usability feature, allowing users to quickly find relevant content without having to scroll through multiple lists.



Figure 26: First impression on the app

What Was Liked and Disliked

The reviewer appreciated the overall clarity of the interface, particularly the search and filtering functionality, which made navigation efficient and reduced unnecessary cognitive effort. The streamlined design contributed to a smooth and enjoyable user experience.

Two issues were identified. First, refreshing the page during an ongoing quiz caused the game view to break, resulting in a blank screen and leaving the user unable to continue or recover the session. Second, it was suggested to implement a "Play Again" button after completing a quiz on the score screen. This way the user can replay a quiz with the same settings chosen at first.

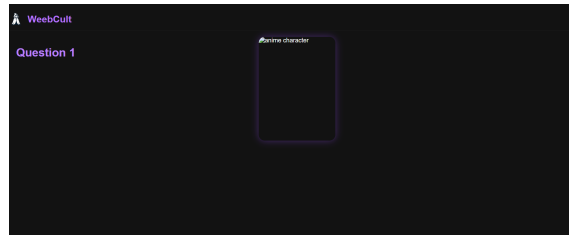


Figure 27: Identified issue with refreshing the game screen

What Would Be Changed, Added, or Removed

Based on this feedback, the following improvements were identified:

- Adding a *Play Again* button on the post-quiz screen to allow users to quickly replay the same quiz.
- Improving error handling and state restoration to ensure that refreshing the page mid-quiz does not result in a broken or unusable game state.

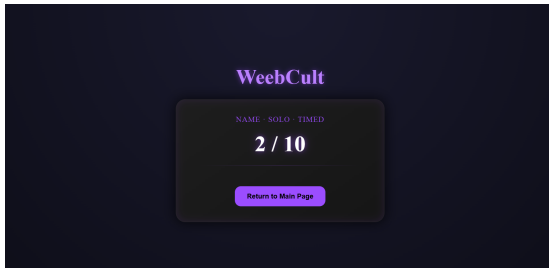


Figure 28: Score screen before feedback

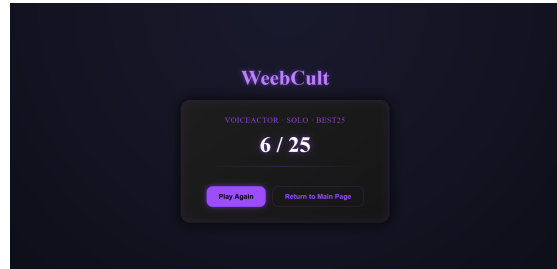


Figure 29: Score screen after feedback

Small Feedback

Overall, the reviewer found the application to be highly polished and easy to use. The feedback emphasized that adding replay functionality and handling unexpected user actions, such as page refreshes during gameplay, would further improve robustness and user satisfaction.

Feedback 8

First Impression

The reviewer reported a positive first impression of the application, stating that the overall concept and functionality fit very well for an anime-based quiz platform. The design was perceived as visually appealing and coherent with the theme, and the quiz functionality was described as working very well.

What Was Liked and Disliked

The reviewer appreciated the overall design and the quiz experience, noting that the application felt enjoyable and functional. The anime-based structure and quiz mechanics were seen as well implemented and engaging.

However, several usability issues were identified, particularly for first-time users. It was unclear that the anime lists on the main page could be scrolled horizontally, and users could not easily see how many items were available in each list. Additionally, the home page was perceived as somewhat cluttered for new users, making it difficult to know what to do first.

The quiz setup process also caused some confusion, as the choices for category, mode, and quiz type were not immediately obvious or clearly interactive. Furthermore, the reviewer raised questions related to user accounts and leaderboard transparency, such as the purpose of logging in, whether accounts can be deleted, how many players are shown on the leaderboard, and how often the leaderboard is updated.

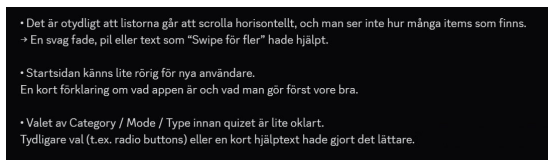


Figure 30: feedback on the app

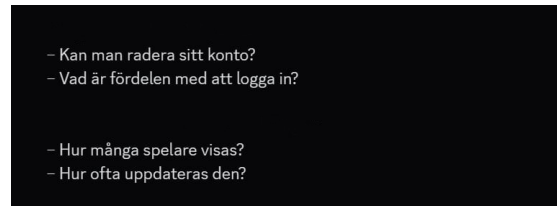


Figure 31: feedback on the app

What Would Be Changed, Added, or Removed

Based on this feedback, the following improvements were identified:

- Making horizontal scrolling more explicit through partial card cut-offs.
- Adding a short introductory explanation describing what the app is and what users should do first.
- Clarifying quiz setup options using clearer controls (radio styled buttons).
- Providing clearer information regarding user accounts, including the benefits of logging in, leaderboard scope, update frequency, and account management options. Since deleting accounts is not within the scope of the course, this was not implemented or used.

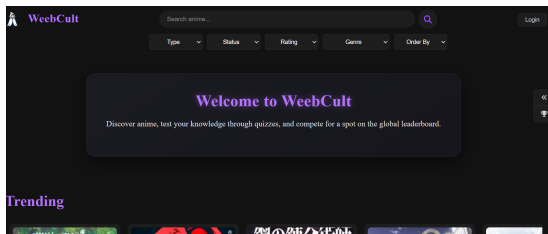


Figure 32: Improvement for the main screen after the feedback

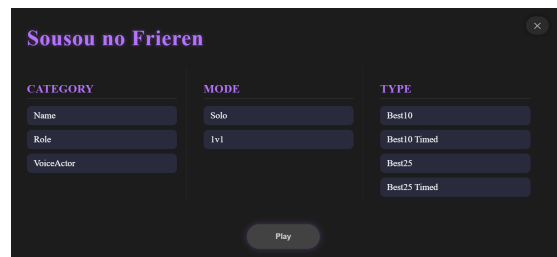


Figure 33: Quiz options after feedback

Small Feedback

Overall, the reviewer found the application enjoyable and well designed, with a quiz experience that worked reliably and felt satisfying. The feedback highlighted that improving onboarding clarity, interaction affordances, and transparency around user accounts and leaderboards would further enhance usability, especially for first-time users.

Formative Evaluation Summary

The formative evaluation of *WeebCult* provided valuable insights into both the strengths of the application and areas where usability, interaction clarity, and robustness could be improved. Feedback was collected from multiple reviewers with different levels of familiarity with anime and web applications, which helped ensure that the evaluation captured perspectives from both the target audience and first-time or non-anime users.

Overall, the application received consistently positive feedback regarding its visual design, concept, and architectural structure. Reviewers frequently highlighted the cohesive color scheme, engaging layout, and interactive elements such as animated loaders, flip-card components in the sidebar, and genre-based anime rows. The quiz concept itself was seen as enjoyable and motivating, with features such as multiple quiz modes, categories, and a global leaderboard contributing to a sense of replayability and competition. Notably, several reviewers stated that the app was enjoyable even for users who were not initially anime fans, indicating that the application has broader appeal beyond its primary target audience.

The most recurring usability issues identified across the feedback related to visibility of system status, onboarding clarity, and interaction affordances. Several reviewers noted that loading states were not always clearly communicated, particularly under slower network conditions, leading to moments where users were unsure whether the application was loading or had failed. This feedback motivated the introduction and refinement of suspense views and loading indicators. Similarly, error handling and user feedback for invalid actions, such as starting a quiz without selecting required options or refreshing the page mid-quiz, were identified as important areas for improvement.

Another common theme was the need for clearer guidance for first-time users. While experienced users could discover functionality through exploration, new users sometimes found the home page overwhelming or were unsure how to begin. Suggestions such as adding a short introductory text, clearer labeling of buttons and icons, and more explicit quiz setup controls (e.g., radio buttons or explanatory text) highlighted the importance of recognition over recall and reducing cognitive load. These insights directly influenced improvements to onboarding and quiz configuration clarity.

Navigation robustness was also identified as an area requiring attention. Issues such as the browser back button leading to a blank page or the lack of a clear way to cancel an ongoing quiz reduced user control and freedom. Addressing these edge cases improved the overall stability of the application and ensured a smoother navigation experience.

Finally, feedback related to content presentation and feedback after user actions played an important role in shaping the final design. The addition of a dedicated score screen after quiz completion, replay options, clearer placeholders for missing character images, and improved labeling of sidebar and leaderboard controls significantly enhanced the sense of closure, feedback, and polish in the application.

In summary, the formative evaluation confirmed that *WeebCult* has a strong conceptual foundation, a solid technical architecture, and an engaging user experience. The feedback helped identify and address usability gaps related to system feedback, onboarding, navigation, and interaction clarity. By iteratively incorporating these insights, the application evolved from a visually strong prototype into a more robust, user-friendly, and complete quiz platform that aligns well with both usability principles and the course grading criteria.